

Storage Solutions for 4 Commonly Ignored Items

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



The best interior designers can create spaces that flow, living rooms that promote conversation and enclaves that shimmer with bright and inviting colors. But there will always be the opportunity for a homeowner to clutter any beautifully designed space. The following storage solutions are for the average person who might unwittingly let the little things in life become constant storage headaches.

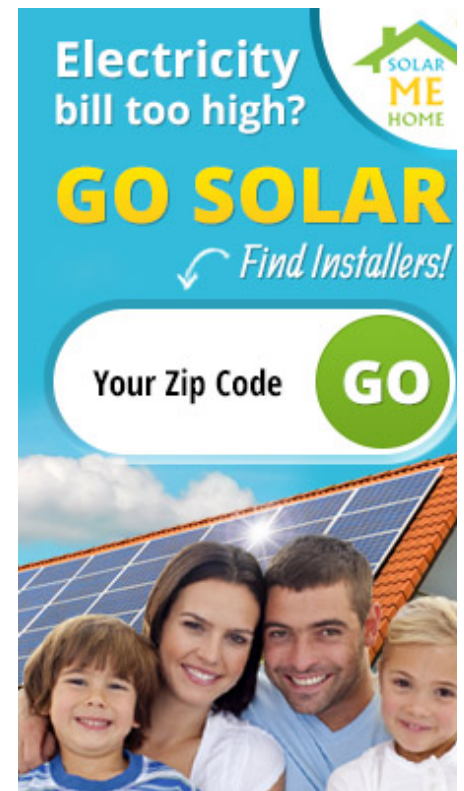
Tame Those Tupperware Lids

So maybe Frank Lloyd Wright designed your house, and you might have spent hundreds of thousands of dollars making sure your home flows with positive energy. But there is one small item for which no designer or architect would spend time planning efficient storage: Tupperware lids.

What may have originally seemed like a well-organized shelf of Tupperware lids will likely devolve into a constant risk of avalanching plastic containers and lids each time you open that cabinet door. When you're just looking to grab a container to save the leftover mac and cheese, you don't want to have to pick up the rest of your plastic container collection that fell onto the floor.

A simple solution involves an inexpensive lid organizer (<http://bit.ly/1GyCkll>) that allows you to vertically sort your Tupperware lids. This handy kitchen storage solution keeps your lids separated from the containers and helps prevent plastic from pouring out of your cabinets. With this method, you can file your lids any way you wish. You may sort them by shape, size, or even color. Jessica from BrightNest.com understands the pains of a disorganized Tupperware storage system (<http://bit.ly/1ulvEUM>) by exclaiming, "Nothing is worse than having ten circular lids when all you need is a square one!"

I use this solution at home, and I can personally vouch for the ease of use and hassle-free upkeep



(<https://solarmehome.com/?cid=28806>)



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of my Tupperware lids. The containers remain easy to stack and retrieve since the lids don't clog up the same shelf. This is one of those storage nightmares that the average homeowner just puts up with. I know I did, for years.

Alternative Use for a Kitchen Broom Closet

A blue rectangular advertisement for FreeScore360. The text "FreeScore360" is in large white font, with a blue circular arrow icon to the right. Below it, in smaller white text, is "with your 7-day Trial & a monthly rebill of \$29.95". At the bottom, in large white text, is "Click Here to get started!".

FreeScore360
with your 7-day Trial
& a monthly rebill of \$29.95
Click Here
to get started!

(<https://secure.rspcdn.com/xpr/r/PID/3569/SID>)

A rectangular advertisement for "Your Home Windows". The top half has a blue background with the text "Your Home Windows" in white. Below this is a photo of a man in a red shirt and white cap working on a window. To the right of the photo, the text "Replace Or Repair" is written in orange. Below the photo, a blue speech bubble contains the text "Affordable Price". To the right of the speech bubble is a red button with white text that says "GET FREE ESTIMATE". At the bottom, the website "www.ewindowquotes.com" is written in white on an orange background.

Your Home Windows
Replace Or Repair
Affordable Price
GET FREE ESTIMATE
www.ewindowquotes.com

(9nl.it/replaceorrepair)

A rectangular advertisement for "Rental Kharma". The top left has the logo "Rental Kharma" with a red flower icon. Below the logo is a photo of a woman in a blue tank top looking at a laptop. To the right of the photo, the text "BUILD YOUR CREDIT WITH YOUR RENT PAYMENTS" is written in large orange letters. Below the photo is an orange button with white text that says "GET STARTED NOW". To the right of the button is a list of four benefits, each preceded by a red checkmark: "Easy Registration", "Get Credit for Past Rent", "Money Back Guarantee", and "3 minute sign up".

Rental Kharma
BUILD YOUR CREDIT WITH YOUR RENT PAYMENTS
GET STARTED NOW
✓ Easy Registration
✓ Get Credit for Past Rent
✓ Money Back Guarantee
✓ 3 minute sign up

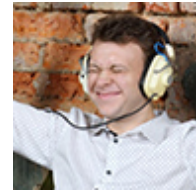
(<https://secure.rspcdn.com/xpr/r/PID/3960/SID>
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We all dream of finding the perfect home. We obsess over the number of bedrooms, being close to good schools, and



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Our place came equipped with a broom closet in the kitchen. When we moved in we threw our broom and dustpan in there since that seemed like the right thing to do. But as we began living in our new place we realized just how limited our kitchen cabinet storage really was. Cereal boxes and cans of soup had no home, and ended up in that no man's land on top of the fridge. While it was nice having a place to stash the broom, what we really needed was a pantry.

A quick trip to Ikea and an afternoon with a hacksaw provided us with custom-sized pantry shelves. For less than \$100 we created five new shelves where we were able to store all that food that had no home before, with room to spare.

Christina from no29design.com says that on top of adding shelves, "baskets are helping [keep this pantry organized \(http://bit.ly/1yfgraW\)](http://bit.ly/1yfgraW) as well. One for baking items, one for mixed nuts and dried fruit, a glass container for available snacks, and big plastic containers for cereal."

It pays to look at the space you have and how you use it. A simple set of freestanding shelves can come in all shapes and sizes and can often be cut to fit perfectly. And when space comes at a premium where you live, you owe it to yourself to maximize your kitchen storage.

Store Bikes Indoors Efficiently



If you care about your bike you likely store it indoors to protect it from the elements. Maybe you have a spot in your garage, or somewhere in your home. If you have two bikes, your headaches double. Normally, this is where blogs would tell you to buy a mount for the wall or ceiling and store your bikes by hanging them off the floor.

In this instance, vertical space is the secret to storing bikes, but this solution doesn't require damaging your wall with big anchors and installed mounts. A free-standing gravity rack takes no more floor space than a single bike, but its accommodating design can comfortably store two bikes.

Katie from roomations.com notes, "If don't own your place—and you want your full security deposit returned when you move out—you'll probably want to [stay away from bicycle wall-mounts](http://bit.ly/1yfgEe9) (<http://bit.ly/1yfgEe9>) and ceiling mounts that require you to drill holes in the wall."

The physics behind the gravity rack may seem dubious, but these racks truly do work. Built with a slim, unobtrusive aluminum tube, a gravity rack harmlessly leans against the wall and lets the bikes remain the center of attention while keeping them off the floor and consolidated in the surface space of a single bike.

End Table Storage



It can be easy to overload your end tables with a collection of odds and ends. A surface that once held a small lamp and a coaster or two can quickly become a wasteland of forgotten mail, snack wrappers, magazines, and a bowl of leftovers that's becoming a moldy science project. In short, end tables are magnets for these kinds of messes.

Consider assigning a specific function to your end tables. Both of our end tables are dedicated to vinyl record storage, leaving the top surface clear with only a lamp on each. This allows us to keep about 100 records stored neatly and easily accessible in a spot that could've been overtaken by junk. It looks good, too. These records wouldn't have had a home if it weren't for these end tables, which would have just compounded our storage headaches.

Takeaway

The goal for storage in the home is to keep what you need organized and easily accessible. Stacking stuff upon stuff in your closet may keep your storage out of sight, but it is a surefire way to lose track of your possessions. This will also create a headache when you need that one thing that happens to be on the bottom of the pile.

Thinking smart about your storage, even with simple things, such as Tupperware lids, may continually save you time and grant you peace of mind. And that is important when managing a clean, organized and happy home.

Chaz Wilke is an employee of Deka Marketing Group. Deka Marketing Group receives payment from advertisers on HomeLiving101.

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